

LONE RANGER
Rahul Gandhi addresses a press conference at Indira Bhawan, Delhi, Aug. 29

IANS

LOOSE CONNECTIONS

- Rahul often 'flies solo'. He spots an issue, frames the attack and acts quickly. Other Congress leaders and the organisation frequently come in only after the political line has been set
- The Congress scion can generate crowds, headlines and social media momentum, but state units have repeatedly failed to convert that energy into sustained mobilisation, booth strength or votes
- At times, party governments in the states, local power centres are at variance with Rahul's national messaging. State-level contradictions dilute his ideological project
- Rahul's engagement with party organisation intensifies around yatras, elections and at times of crisis, but routine work of enforcing discipline, building structures and resolving factionalism meanders
- Same disconnect exists with the larger Opposition. Rahul has good personal ties with several leaders, but Congress fails to leverage this consistently in strategic coordination or consensus over leadership. Allies remain wary of the party